

Special circumstances

Since starting at McMaster in 2002, I have had four episodes of major depression. The first three were in 2005, 2013, and 2015. Unwisely, instead of taking the time necessary to heal at any of those opportunities, I pushed ahead with a work schedule that distracted me, but did not address my health needs. In 2025 I had another episode of major depression that was darker and longer than any of the preceding ones. Finally, I realized that I needed to recover, and was on medical leave from the university from November, 2025, until April 2026. This period of time away from work accounts for a gap in my teaching record and a decrease in my research activities, including grant writing and publishing.